

Cold Email Templates for Restaurants and Hospitality

Proven Outreach Templates to Fill Tables, Win Corporate Clients, and Build a Loyal Customer Base

Published by Sovereign Digital Agency

Updated March 2026

Sovereign Digital Agency - sovereigndigitalagency.co.uk.

How to Use This Template Pack

This pack contains 10 cold email templates designed for restaurants, bars, cafes, catering companies, and hospitality venues. Whether you are pursuing corporate event bookings, building relationships with food bloggers, reaching out to local businesses for regular catering, or winning back guests who have not visited in months, these templates deliver results.

Hospitality is sensory, emotional, and deeply personal. Unlike B2B SaaS or consulting, your product is an experience. These templates are written to evoke that experience through vivid language while maintaining the professionalism needed for business outreach.

Each template includes a subject line, full email body, and a clear call to action.

- Replace all bracketed placeholders [like this] with your venue details, menu highlights, and specific offers
- Best send times: Monday-Tuesday 10-11am for corporate contacts; Thursday-Friday 11am-1pm for weekend booking pushes
- Include a link to your menu, photos, or virtual tour in every email -- hospitality is a visual sale
- Wait 4-5 business days between follow-ups for corporate prospects; 7 days for individual guests
- Personalise by referencing the recipient's company events, dietary requirements, or neighbourhood
- Always include your address, phone number, and booking link in your email signature

Template 1: Initial Outreach -- Corporate Event and Private Dining

SUBJECT LINE: Your next team event at [Restaurant Name] -- private dining for [Company Name]

Hi [First Name],

I am [Your Name], [Title] at [Restaurant Name] in [Area]. I am reaching out to a select group of companies near our venue because I think we could host your team events in a way that goes beyond the typical corporate dinner.

Our private dining space accommodates [Number] guests and offers:

- A dedicated events co-ordinator who manages every detail from menu planning to dietary requirements
- Bespoke menus designed by our head chef around your preferences, budget, and any dietary needs
- Full AV setup for presentations, with complimentary high-speed Wi-Fi
- Flexible packages starting from [Amount] per person for [course count]-course menus, including [drinks/welcome reception]

We have hosted events for companies including [Client 1], [Client 2], and [Client 3], and our repeat booking rate is [X]% -- which I think speaks to the experience we deliver.

I would love to show you the space. A 15-minute venue tour would give you a much better feel than any email can provide.

CTA: Would you like to arrange a complimentary tasting and venue tour? Reply with a convenient date or call me directly at [Phone].

WHY THIS WORKS: Corporate events are the highest-margin bookings for most restaurants. This template leads with specific capabilities and social proof rather than generic hospitality language.

1. Research the company's size and recent events to tailor the capacity and package you mention
2. The complimentary tasting is a powerful conversion tool -- let the food do the selling
3. Include your repeat booking rate to signal quality and reliability

Template 2: Initial Outreach -- Food Blogger or Influencer Invitation

SUBJECT LINE: [Influencer Name], an invitation to experience [Restaurant Name]

Hi [First Name],

I am a big fan of your work -- particularly [specific content reference -- e.g., your recent review of Restaurant X / your series on hidden gems in Area / your honest take on the new tasting menu trend]. Your perspective is refreshing, and your audience clearly trusts your recommendations.

I would like to invite you to experience [Restaurant Name] as our guest. We recently [newsworthy element -- e.g., launched a new seasonal menu / brought on a new head chef from Michelin-starred Restaurant X / introduced a unique dining concept], and I think it would genuinely interest you and your followers.

The invitation includes:

- A complimentary [course count]-course tasting menu for you and a guest
- A meet-and-greet with our head chef, [Chef Name], who can walk you through the menu inspiration and sourcing
- No posting requirements or editorial guidelines. If you love it, we would be thrilled for you to share. If you do not, we would rather have your honest feedback so we can improve

We are located at [Address], and I can arrange your visit any evening that works for your schedule.

CTA: Interested? Reply with your preferred date and any dietary requirements, and I will handle everything.

WHY THIS WORKS: Food influencers are the most cost-effective marketing channel for restaurants. The no-obligation approach builds trust, and a chef meet-and-greet provides exclusive content that followers love.

1. Reference specific content to prove you genuinely follow their work, not just their follower count
2. The no-posting-requirement stance actually increases the likelihood of authentic, enthusiastic coverage
3. Chef meet-and-greets provide behind-the-scenes content that performs exceptionally well on social media

Template 3: Initial Outreach -- Local Business Catering Partnership

SUBJECT LINE: Lunch for your team at [Company Name] -- delivered from [Restaurant Name]

Hi [First Name],

I run [Restaurant Name] just [distance] from your office on [Street], and I wanted to propose something I think your team would love.

We have started a corporate catering programme for local businesses, and the response has been fantastic. Here is why companies like [Client 1] and [Client 2] order from us every week:

- Fresh, chef-prepared meals delivered to your office by [time]
- Rotating menus so your team never eats the same thing twice in a month
- Dietary accommodations as standard -- vegan, gluten-free, halal, and allergen-free options always available
- Group ordering made simple through our online portal -- each person selects their meal by [deadline]
- Transparent pricing: [Amount] per person for [meal description], with volume discounts for regular orders

For your first order, I would like to offer [Company Name] a complimentary lunch for up to [Number] people. No commitment, no contract -- just great food and a chance to experience the quality.

CTA: Want to try the free lunch? Reply with your team size and preferred delivery day, and I will send you this week's menu.

WHY THIS WORKS: Regular corporate catering is recurring revenue with predictable margins. The free lunch for the whole team is a powerful offer because it creates shared enthusiasm and peer pressure to continue ordering.

1. Target businesses within a 15-minute delivery radius to ensure food arrives fresh and hot
2. The free group lunch is more effective than an individual free meal because it creates social proof within the company
3. Emphasise the online ordering system -- convenience is the primary driver of repeat corporate catering orders

Template 4: Follow-Up -- After No Response to Event Enquiry (Day 5)

SUBJECT LINE: Re: [Original Subject Line] -- plus a seasonal offer

Hi [First Name],

I reached out earlier this week about hosting [Company Name]'s events at [Restaurant Name]. I know event planning competes with a thousand other priorities, so I will keep this brief.

I wanted to mention that we have [X] private dining dates remaining for [Month/Season], and they are filling quickly. Our [Season] menu features [highlight dishes -- e.g., locally sourced game, truffle risotto, and a dessert selection that has become genuinely famous in Area].

For bookings confirmed this month, I am including:

- Complimentary welcome drinks for all guests
- A bespoke cocktail created for your company by our head bartender
- Priority rebooking rights for your next event

I have also attached our private dining brochure with photos, sample menus, and pricing so you can review at your convenience.

CTA: Shall I pencil in a date for you while availability lasts? Reply with your preferred date and group size.

WHY THIS WORKS: Seasonal availability creates genuine scarcity for event bookings. The added bonuses (welcome drinks, custom cocktail) increase perceived value without significantly increasing cost.

1. Limited seasonal availability is genuine urgency in hospitality -- use it honestly
2. Attach a PDF brochure with professional photos -- hospitality is sold visually
3. The custom cocktail offer costs almost nothing to deliver but feels premium and memorable

Template 5: Follow-Up -- Social Proof and Reviews (Day 12)

SUBJECT LINE: What [Company Name/Influencer Name] said about [Restaurant Name]

Hi [First Name],

I wanted to share a few recent highlights that might help you get a feel for [Restaurant Name]:

[Choose 2-3 of the following:]

- '[Review quote -- e.g., The best private dining experience we have had in London. The team went above and beyond for our annual gala.]' -- [Company Name], [Number] guests, [Date]
- We were recently awarded [achievement -- e.g., a Michelin Bib Gourmand / a 4.8-star rating on Google with 500+ reviews / Best Restaurant in Area by Publication]
- [Influencer Name] visited last month and called our [Dish] 'the best they have had in 2026.' Their post reached [Number] people: [Link]
- Our last [Number] corporate events achieved a [X]% guest satisfaction rating based on post-event surveys

I share these not to boast but because choosing a venue for your team or guests is a significant decision, and I want you to feel confident that [Restaurant Name] delivers consistently.

CTA: The best way to evaluate us is to taste for yourself. Can I arrange a complimentary tasting for you this week? Reply or call [Phone].

WHY THIS WORKS: Social proof from recognisable sources (press, awards, named companies) builds confidence in the venue's quality. The tasting invitation converts interest into action.

1. Collect and document every positive review, press mention, and corporate feedback for use in follow-up emails
2. Guest satisfaction ratings from post-event surveys are particularly persuasive for corporate event planners

3. Linking to influencer posts provides visual, third-party evidence that no amount of self-promotion can match

Template 6: Follow-Up -- Seasonal or Menu Update (Day 18)

SUBJECT LINE: New [Season] menu at [Restaurant Name] -- first look

Hi [First Name],

I wanted to share something exciting before it goes public: our new [Season] menu launches on [Date], and I thought [Company Name / you] would want an early look.

Highlights:

- [Dish 1]: [Brief, appetising description -- e.g., 48-hour slow-braised short rib with smoked bone marrow butter and charred shallot puree]
- [Dish 2]: [Description -- e.g., Charcoal-grilled whole sea bass with preserved lemon, samphire, and a saffron and mussel broth]
- [Dish 3]: [Description -- e.g., Dark chocolate fondant with salted caramel ice cream and honeycomb shards]

Our head chef, [Name], spent three weeks developing this menu with ingredients sourced from [specific provenance -- e.g., farms within 30 miles of our kitchen / sustainable fisheries in Cornwall / our own rooftop herb garden].

I am hosting an exclusive preview evening on [Date] for a small group of guests before the public launch. I would love to include you.

CTA: Want to join the preview dinner? Reply 'Count me in' and I will reserve your place. Limited to [Number] guests.

WHY THIS WORKS: Exclusive early access to a new menu creates a sense of being in the 'inner circle.' The vivid dish descriptions engage the senses and create anticipation, while the preview dinner is a high-conversion event.

1. Describe dishes with sensory language -- flavours, textures, techniques -- that make the reader taste the food through the email
2. Limited preview dinners create genuine exclusivity and convert cold leads into enthusiastic guests
3. Mentioning ingredient provenance signals quality and care -- increasingly important to modern diners

Template 7: Break-Up -- Open Invitation

SUBJECT LINE: The door is always open at [Restaurant Name], [First Name]

Hi [First Name],

I have reached out a few times about [context -- hosting your events / catering for your team / welcoming you as a guest], and I appreciate your time even if the timing has not been right. This will be my last email.

I want to leave you with a standing invitation:

- Corporate events: Our private dining space is available year-round. When your next event comes around, we would love to be considered: [Booking Link]
- Catering: Our corporate catering menu is online at [Link] -- you can place an order anytime with 48 hours notice
- Personal dining: This email entitles you to a complimentary glass of champagne on your first visit. Just show it to your server. No expiry

Whatever brought you to my inbox, I hope [Company Name / you] thrive, and I hope we get to welcome you to [Restaurant Name] one day.

CTA: Save this email for when the time is right. We will be here.

WHY THIS WORKS: The complimentary champagne offer gives the recipient a tangible reason to save the email rather than delete it. This break-up email frequently converts weeks or months later when the prospect has a specific occasion to celebrate.

1. The redeemable champagne offer costs very little but creates a lasting impression and a reason to visit
2. Providing permanent links to event and catering information enables self-service when the timing is right
3. Hospitality break-up emails should feel warm and inviting, not transactional

Template 8: Break-Up -- Redirect to Social Connection

SUBJECT LINE: Stay connected, [First Name] -- even without an email

Hi [First Name],

This is my last email about [context], and I want to make sure there is still a way for us to stay on each other's radar.

Even if email outreach is not the right channel, you might enjoy following [Restaurant Name] on social media where we share:

- Behind-the-scenes kitchen content and chef interviews
- First looks at new menus and seasonal specials
- Exclusive offers that we do not advertise anywhere else
- Stories from our team, our suppliers, and our community

Find us at:

- Instagram: [Handle]
- TikTok: [Handle]
- Facebook: [Handle]

And if you ever want to try us, our online booking is always open: [Link]

CTA: Give us a follow, and I promise our content is worth the space on your feed. If you ever want to chat about events or catering, I am a DM away.

WHY THIS WORKS: Redirecting to social media maintains the connection through a lower-commitment channel. Social followers are warm leads who convert over time through consistent exposure to your content.

1. Social media followers who came from cold email outreach convert to diners at 3-5x the rate of organic followers
2. Your social content does the ongoing selling that email cannot sustain without becoming annoying
3. The DM invitation keeps a personal communication channel open without the formality of email

Template 9: Re-Engagement -- Guest Who Has Not Returned

SUBJECT LINE: [First Name], your table misses you -- plus something special

Hi [First Name],

It has been [timeframe] since your last visit to [Restaurant Name], and we have been thinking about you. Our team remembers your [specific detail if available -- e.g., love for our seafood risotto / birthday celebration in our private room / regular Friday evening visits], and we would love to welcome you back.

Since your last visit, we have been busy:

- [Update 1 -- e.g., A completely new seasonal menu designed by our head chef]
- [Update 2 -- e.g., We renovated our terrace -- it is now the best outdoor dining space in Area]
- [Update 3 -- e.g., We launched a Sunday brunch that has already become one of the most popular in the city]

To welcome you back, I have arranged a special offer exclusively for returning guests:

- [Offer -- e.g., A complimentary bottle of wine with any table booking this month / 20% off your next meal for up to 4 guests / A free dessert course for your whole table]

CTA: Ready to return? Reply with your preferred date and party size, or book online at [Link]. Your returning guest offer will be applied automatically.

WHY THIS WORKS: Lapsed guest re-engagement is one of the most cost-effective marketing activities for restaurants. The personal touch (remembering their preferences) demonstrates that your hospitality extends beyond the visit.

1. Reference specific details from their previous visits if your booking system stores this information
2. Highlighting new additions gives returning guests a fresh reason to visit beyond nostalgia
3. Exclusive returning-guest offers create a sense of valued loyalty that generic discounts cannot match

Template 10: Re-Engagement -- Cancelled or Abandoned Booking

SUBJECT LINE: [First Name], your reservation at [Restaurant Name] -- shall we reschedule?

Hi [First Name],

I noticed that your reservation for [Date] at [Restaurant Name] was [cancelled / not completed]. No worries at all -- plans

change, and we completely understand.

I wanted to reach out personally because I know you were looking forward to [specific context if known -- e.g., your anniversary dinner / the team celebration / trying our new tasting menu], and I do not want a scheduling conflict to mean you miss out entirely.

We have availability on the following dates:

- [Date 1] at [Time]
- [Date 2] at [Time]
- [Date 3] at [Time]

And to make rebooking easy, I am including a small thank-you for giving us another chance:

- [Incentive -- e.g., Complimentary welcome cocktails for your party / A guaranteed window table / A personal greeting from our head chef]

CTA: Want to rebook? Reply with which date works best and your party size. I will take care of everything.

WHY THIS WORKS: Cancelled bookings represent lost revenue that is easily recovered with a timely, personal follow-up. Offering specific alternative dates removes the friction of rescheduling.

1. Send this email within 24-48 hours of the cancellation while the intent is still fresh
2. Providing specific available dates is more effective than asking them to check the booking system
3. The small incentive (welcome cocktail, window table) costs almost nothing but tips the decision toward rebooking

Tips for Improving Open and Reply Rates

Hospitality email outreach succeeds when it makes the recipient feel something -- anticipation, exclusivity, warmth, or excitement. These tips will help your outreach create those emotional responses while driving measurable bookings and revenue.

1. Write for the senses: Describe dishes, atmospheres, and experiences using sensory language. 'Hand-rolled pasta with a truffle cream sauce' creates desire in a way that 'Italian restaurant with pasta options' never will
2. Include visuals whenever possible: Attach or link to professional food photography, venue photos, or short video clips. Hospitality is sold through the eyes first
3. Make booking effortless: Every email should include a direct booking link, phone number, and reply option. The fewer clicks between 'interested' and 'booked,' the higher your conversion rate
4. Leverage seasonality: Seasonal menu launches, holiday events, and limited-time offers create natural urgency and a reason to reach out that feels timely rather than pushy
5. Target the right decision-maker: For corporate outreach, target office managers, executive assistants, and HR teams -- they are usually responsible for booking team events and ordering catering
6. Follow up around key dates: Reach out 3-4 weeks before Christmas, Valentine's Day, Mother's Day, and end-of-financial-year when corporate and personal dining demand peaks
7. Collect and showcase reviews: A single genuine review from a recognisable company or influencer is worth more

than any discount offer. Build your review portfolio systematically

8. Offer exclusivity: Preview dinners, chef's table experiences, and menu tastings convert cold leads into warm guests because they feel like privileged access rather than a sales pitch
9. Personalise with dining history: If your booking system records past visits, preferences, and special occasions, reference them. Remembered preferences signal genuine hospitality
10. Track booking conversions, not just opens: The only metric that matters for restaurant email outreach is whether it fills seats. Track which emails generate the most confirmed bookings and invest in those templates

Disclaimer: These templates are provided for informational and educational purposes only. Results will vary based on your venue, location, and personalisation effort. Always comply with applicable email marketing laws including CAN-SPAM, GDPR, and PECR. Sovereign Digital Agency is not responsible for outcomes resulting from the use of these templates.

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